

MENTOR SPOTLIGHT

# MENTOR SPOTLIGHT

*The Mentor Who Taught Me Not to Shrink*

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Ms. Fegs Umuteme Oghenefego Peace

*Presented by Deborah Pelumi · HNG i14 VA Track · June 2026*

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# WHO IS MS. FECS?

*Umutepe Oghenekego Peace known in the VA track as Ms. Fecs.*

## Executive Assistant

Strategic Operator & Partner to Founders at ArcnetLabs, Abuja

## 500+ connections on LinkedIn

An active, established professional with real credibility

## HNG i14 VA Track Mentor

Led and supported VA interns across multiple stages

## Her style in one line

Warm on the outside. Firm on the inside. Always intentional.

## What made her different

She invested in our mindset, not just our deliverables.



# HER MENTORSHIP STYLE

01

## HOW SHE SHOWED UP

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*Consistent. Present. Reliable.*

She was there from Stage 1 and still speaking into the group at Stage 9. That kind of consistency builds trust without saying a word.

02

## HOW SHE COMMUNICATED

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*Direct. No wasted words.*

Every message had a point. She celebrated you and reminded you not to slack in the same breath. That balance is rare.

03

## WHAT SHE CARED ABOUT

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*Your mindset, not just your output.*

She pushed us to think about who we were becoming, not just what we were submitting. That's a different level of mentorship.

# REAL MOMENT 01

8 May 2026

*The Letter to Your Future Self*

Ms. Fegs asked everyone to write a note to their Stage 10 self. Not a caption. A real, personal message.

I didn't post mine on the Slack channel. I was scared. I wasn't sure I was going to make it to Stage 10 and posting felt like making a promise I didn't know I could keep.

So I wrote it to myself. In private. Sent it to my own personal note

*"Remember this night, Pelumi. Remember the hunger. That's what brought you here. Don't let it go. God's grace carried me this far. It won't stop now."*

That's what her activity did. It didn't just give me something to write. It made me honest with myself.

# REAL MOMENT 02

28 May 2026

*"Give yourself the accolades you deserve. You truly deserve it. You didn't come this far just to come this far. Don't slack. It'd be sad to pack your bags after coming this far."*

— Ms. Fegs, Slack #track-virtual-assistant

01

**She saw us when we were tired.**

By Stage 8 everyone was exhausted. She didn't ignore that. She acknowledged how far we'd come and then reminded us not to stop.

02

**She balanced celebration with accountability.**

She made you feel proud and then in the same message reminded you the work wasn't done. That combination is hard to do well. She did it naturally.

# WHAT SHE MODELLED

*Don't let anything limit you.*

● **She showed up knowing her worth.**

She didn't wait to feel ready. She operated like someone who already knew what she was doing.

● **She never apologised for taking up space.**

Her presence in the channel was consistent and confident. That alone taught something.

● **She modelled what a professional VA looks like.**

Not just skills the presence, the communication, the follow-through.

● **She made us believe we were allowed to grow.**

Watching her made me realise I was allowed to take up space the same way.

# COMMUNICATION STYLE

01

## HER TONE

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*Warm but direct.*

She never made you feel small. But she also never wrapped feedback in so much softness that the point got lost. Clear and kind both at once.

02

## HER TIMING

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*She showed up at the right moments.*

When people were tired and close to the end, she was there. Not with a task review with perspective. That's rare from a mentor.

03

## HER IMPACT

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*She changed how I saw myself.*

Before HNG I would not have called myself confident. Watching Ms. Fegs operate made me realise confidence is not a feeling it's a decision.



# LESSONS FOR FUTURE VAs

*What every VA can take from the way Ms. Fegs led.*

01

## **Invest in people's mindset, not just their output.**

The best leaders make you believe in yourself before they teach you the tool. Ms. Fegs did this consistently her channel messages were not just reminders, they were perspective shifts.

02

## **Show up consistently.**

She was there from Stage 1 and still speaking into the group at Stage 9. That kind of consistent presence builds trust without saying a word. Just show up every time.

03

## **Don't shrink.**

Your skills are real. Your growth is real. Own it out loud, without apology. Ms. Fegs showed us that confidence is not arrogance. It's just knowing what you bring and not hiding it.

# FINAL TAKEAWAY

- **Ms. Fegs didn't just mentor VAs.**

She mentored people who were becoming professionals. There is a difference.

- **Anyone can teach you to manage an inbox.**

Not everyone can teach you to stop being afraid of your own potential.

- **She did both.**

From Stage 1 to Stage 9 she paid attention to where people's heads were.

- **The lesson I'm taking with me:**

Show up. Be consistent. Don't shrink. Know your worth and keep going.

Thank you,  
Ms. Fegs ★